

FIRST NEWS

Friday, October 9, 2026 | Covering the Thursday, October 8 session *Employing Intelligent Investing***PSEi -2.20% to 5,610 as Oil Tops \$102; Foreigners Sell ₱1.18B; a ₱12.4B Meralco Block Lifts Turnover to ₱21.1B**

The PSEi opened at 5,727.76, touched 5,744.40, then slid all session to close on its low at 5,610.39 (-126.30), just 26 points above the Nov-2025 low of 5,584.35. Breadth was 73 up and 112 down. A Persian Gulf tanker attack and reports that President Trump may order strikes on Iran pushed Brent above \$102 and WTI near \$90, and the 10-year US yield stayed above 5.3%. Foreigners sold a net ₱1.185B (₱4.91B bought, ₱6.10B sold), led by ICT, SMPH and MBT. Total value jumped to ₱21.14B, but ₱12.44B of it was a single MER block cross at ₱580.99, 40% above the ₱415 close. Regular main-board value was ₱6.37B.

THE CALL — ACTIONABLE HIGHLIGHTS**🟡 IPO WATCH MYNT (GCash) ₱6.60 final — Offer closes Monday, Oct 12: we would subscribe**

The ₱6.60 price covers 8.03B shares (₱53.0B), plus a 1.2B-share overallotment that would lift the deal to ₱60.9B. Trading Edge estimates 20.4x 2026 earnings against about 25% annual EPS growth and sees fair value near ₱8, a roughly 21% cushion and below our ₱7.00 buy ceiling. A risk-off tape like Thursday's is a reason to use the offer rather than chase after listing. Risks: El Niño could strain GCash's rural and lower-income users, and offer-week cash may be pulled from index names. Listing is Oct 20.

🟡 TENDER FCG (Figaro Culinary) ₱0.67 last — Parent offers ₱0.82 a share to delist it

Figaro Coffee Systems, FCG's parent, plans to delist FCG from the PSE and offer ₱0.82 per share to buy out eligible shareholders, 22% above the last price of ₱0.67. The offer will be funded by a secured loan from China Banking Corp. FCG is on the PSE suspension list, so there is no market price. For holders the tender is the exit being offered: read the tender terms and deadline before deciding, because shares left behind will sit in an unlisted company.

🟡 MONITOR MER ₱415.00 (+0.24%) — ₱12.44B block cross at ₱580.99, 40% above the market

One cross of 21.41M shares, about 1.9% of the company, printed on the block board at ₱580.99, worth ₱12.44B or 59% of the day's total value. Regular trading was calm: ₱128.0M of value, a ₱410–423.80 range and foreign net buying of ₱17.0M. A price 40% above the screen points to a negotiated stake transfer rather than market buying. The DQR does not name the buyer or seller, and we found no matching disclosure. Hold, and do not read ₱580.99 as a re-rating of the stock. Watch for a PSE disclosure.

🟢 ACCUMULATE FPH ₱89.00 (-0.11%) — Held its range while the index fell 2.2%

FPH traded ₱87.50–89.50 and closed ₱89.00 with foreign net buying of ₱2.6M, on thin value of ₱15.1M. The ₱5B buyback (Oct 2026–Sep 2028, about 13.5% of the company at ₱87) and the ₱1.10 dividend remain the floor. The price is about 2% above our ₱87 reference, so buy slowly and on dips to ₱87–88.

🟢 ACCUMULATE AC ₱530.00 (-1.85%) — Pulled back from ₱540 but held above ₱526

AC fell from Oct 7's ₱540 close but held a ₱526.50–540 range on ₱274.9M of value. Foreigners sold ₱58.7M, the seventh-largest net sale of the day. Stay with Accumulate on dips toward ₱515–520; a close below ₱500 would trigger a review.

MONITOR GLO ₱1,516 (−0.98%) — Globe bets AI demand makes data centers its next billion-dollar business

Globe plans about \$1.0B of capex in 2027, most of it for data-related businesses including data centers, and says growing AI demand could turn that unit into its next billion-dollar venture. The stock slipped 0.98% on ₱120.2M of value with foreign selling of ₱70.7M, and sits ₱39 below our ₱1,555 re-entry level. One close above ₱1,555 moves GLO back to Accumulate.

AVOID ICT ₱841.50 (−5.93%) — Closed on its low; foreigners sold ₱326.4M

ICT fell from ₱894.50 to ₱841.50, closing at the session low (high ₱898), on ₱1.28B of regular value, 20% of the main board. Foreign net selling of ₱326.4M was the largest of the day. A 300,000-share block crossed early at ₱895.41, 6% above the close, and the stock is now below the ₱860 it held on Oct 2. Stay out until it recovers ₱895 (Oct 7 close and block price) and foreign selling eases.

AVOID MBT · SMPH · SCC · Miners — Where the foreign selling and the damage were concentrated

MBT −3.30% (foreigners −₱178.1M) and BPI −2.72%. SMPH −2.94% with ₱275.3M of foreign selling, the second-largest of the day. SCC −13.39% to ₱11.00, the worst PSEi member, after a ₱10.90–12.38 range. Miners led the index down: AT −7.21%, APX −4.45%, PX −2.34% as gold, silver and copper slipped. Wait for commodities to stabilize before adding any of these.

SESSION DASHBOARD — THURSDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2026

PSEi	ALL SHARES	NET FOREIGN	BREADTH	USD-PHP
5,610.39	3,145.55	−₱1.185B	73 / 112	62.750
▼ 126.30 / −2.20%	▼ 46.44 / −1.45%	Biggest since Oct 2	Adv / Dec (67 unch)	▼ 2c vs 62.771 (Oct 7 ref)

Metric	Value	Note
PSEi intraday range	5,610.39 – 5,744.40	Opened 5,727.76 and closed on the low; 26 points above the Nov-2025 low (5,584.35)
Main-board value	₱6.368B	Grand total ₱21.139B incl. ₱14.760B of blocks; 100,054 trades; Oct 7 main board was ₱4.421B
Foreign buying / selling	₱4.912B / ₱6.097B	Total foreign ₱11.009B vs ₱6.098B on Oct 7
Net foreign flow	−₱1.185B	Reverses +₱175.6M on Oct 7; Oct 5–8 week −₱1.169B; Oct 2 was −₱1.255B
Week (Oct 5 – Oct 8)	▼ 0.33%	From 5,629.03 on Oct 2: +2.03%, −1.15%, +1.05%, −2.20%
PSEi members higher	11 of 30	SMC +2.67%, MONDE +2.65% and RCR +1.29% led; SCC −13.39% and ICT −5.93% were worst
Support / Resistance	5,584 / 5,745	Nov-2025 low is 0.5% below the close; a break opens 5,500

GLOBAL MARKETS

Wall Street was mixed on Thursday. AI stocks sold off on profit concerns, and the Nasdaq closed sharply lower as technology led a risk-off move, while rising oil and volatile Treasury yields revived inflation fears. Oil jumped after a tanker attack in the Persian Gulf and reports that President Trump may order military strikes on Iran ahead of the US midterms: Brent breached \$102 a barrel and WTI climbed near \$90, reversing global equities immediately. The 10-year Treasury yield has climbed above 5.3%, a multi-year high. Positioning is crowded on the short side, which raises the risk of sharp rebounds in either direction. Our outlook is cautious: oil, bond yields and Q3 earnings, plus persistent inflation, keep rates higher for longer and pressure valuations.

- **The bigger picture:** oil spikes and volatile Treasury yields are the transmission channel from the Middle East to equity valuations. Until oil stops rising and the 10-year stops climbing, rallies in growth and AI names are vulnerable.
- **China:** a pause in China's copper demand weighed on base metals, while the central bank's gold purchases continue, extending a record-long buying streak.

COMMODITIES

Oil was the story. The tanker attack and strike reports sent Brent above \$102 and WTI toward \$90. Precious metals fell as a strong dollar and elevated yields pressured them: gold was flat after hitting a two-month low, and silver dropped 1.9% to \$58.98. Higher yields make US bonds more attractive than assets that pay no interest, although steady central-bank buying, led by China, and geopolitical tension support gold. Copper slipped sharply on the pause in Chinese demand, which hit the Philippine miners.

FX & RATES

A strong dollar and US yields above 5.3% are the pressure points for the peso; the ₱63.00 ceiling that held on Oct 2 is the line to watch. For yields, the watch list is US inflation data, the Fed, oil and Treasury auctions: sticky inflation or higher oil could push yields up, while easing price pressures may bring rates down.

PHILIPPINES STRATEGY

An external shock, with the floor 26 points away. The PSEi gave back more than the previous session's gain in one day and closed on its low, 0.5% above the Nov-2025 low of 5,584.35 that held on Oct 2. Services (-4.86%) and Mining & Oil (-3.43%) did most of the damage. ICT alone fell 5.93%, and Atlas (-7.21%), Apex (-4.45%) and Philex (-2.34%) led the miners lower. Only 11 of 30 index members rose, and the equal-weighted PSEi-30 fell 1.10%.

Where we lean in: Subscribe to Mynt before the offer closes Monday. Accumulate FPH and AC on dips. If you hold FCG, the ₱0.82 tender is the exit on offer. Foreign buyers did show up in a few names: SM (+₱45.0M, up 1.26%), GTCAP (+₱30.2M) and URC (+₱17.6M), a sign of selectivity rather than a full exit.

What to avoid: ICT, the banks (MBT -₱178.1M, BPI), SMPH (-₱275.3M), SCC and the miners until commodities stabilize. We want a close back above 5,745 (Thursday's high) before calling this correction over.

- **Property:** S&P says the Philippine residential recovery may take until late 2027 (BusinessWorld headline; we could not open the full article). The Property index fell 1.02%. We treat the sector as a slow story, not a near-term catalyst.
- **Power:** the ERC says about 11,500 businesses can tap the new 100-kW power market (BusinessWorld headline). The effect on Meralco and other suppliers is unconfirmed until we can read the details.

SECTORAL SUMMARY

Sector	Oct 7	Oct 8	% Chg	Value (₱M)
Financials	1,771.18	1,745.90	▼ -1.43%	2,187.6
Industrial	7,271.56	7,265.07	▼ -0.09%	14,104.1
Holding Firms	4,182.80	4,180.46	▼ -0.06%	845.6
Property	1,761.71	1,743.69	▼ -1.02%	1,435.6
Services	3,114.00	2,962.54	▼ -4.86%	2,269.0
Mining & Oil	19,412.24	18,746.94	▼ -3.43%	296.6
PSEi	5,736.69	5,610.39	▼ -2.20%	—
All Shares	3,191.99	3,145.55	▼ -1.45%	—

Services (-4.86%) was the worst sector: ICT -5.93%, PLUS -3.95%, TEL -2.37% and GLO -0.98%. Mining & Oil (-3.43%) followed commodities lower. Holding Firms held up (-0.06%) as SM (+1.26%) and SMC (+2.67%) offset JGS (-3.26%). Industrial value of ₱14.10B includes the ₱12.44B MER block. Sector values include block sales.

FOREIGN FUND FLOW

Foreigners bought ₱4.912B and sold ₱6.097B, a net sale of ₱1.185B, the biggest since Oct 2 (-₱1.255B) and a sharp reversal from Oct 7's +₱175.6M. Three names drove it: ICT (-₱326.4M), SMPH (-₱275.3M) and MBT (-₱178.1M), together ₱779.8M or 66% of the net sale. Buying was small and selective: SM (+₱45.0M), GTCAP (+₱30.2M), WEB (+₱23.7M), URC (+₱17.6M) and MER (+₱17.0M).

Top Net Buys	Close	% Chg	Net (₱)
SM	522.50	▲ +1.26%	+45.0M
GTCAP	418.00	▼ -0.48%	+30.2M
WEB	13.90	0.00%	+23.7M
URC	57.00	▲ +1.15%	+17.6M
MER	415.00	▲ +0.24%	+17.0M
STI	1.26	▼ -1.56%	+8.4M

Top Net Sells	Close	% Chg	Net (₱)
ICT	841.50	▼ -5.93%	(326.4M)
SMPH	15.82	▼ -2.94%	(275.3M)
MBT	60.05	▼ -3.30%	(178.1M)
RLC	16.20	▼ -0.12%	(94.0M)
MWC	31.85	▼ -1.09%	(71.2M)
GLO	1,516.0	▼ -0.98%	(70.7M)

TOP 10 MOST ACTIVE BY VALUE

#	Symbol	Close (P)	% Chg	Value (PM)	Net Foreign
1	ICT	841.50	▼ -5.93%	1,280.7	(326.4M)
2	BDO	111.00	▼ -0.18%	1,045.2	(48.8M)
3	SM	522.50	▲ +1.26%	331.2	+45.0M
4	SMPH	15.82	▼ -2.94%	320.7	(275.3M)
5	MBT	60.05	▼ -3.30%	314.4	(178.1M)
6	BPI	93.00	▼ -2.72%	300.3	(14.7M)
7	AC	530.00	▼ -1.85%	274.9	(58.7M)
8	MEG	2.16	▼ -0.46%	151.8	+1.9M
9	ALI	15.26	▼ -0.91%	150.4	+4.5M
10	AT	17.50	▼ -7.21%	150.0	(16.4M)

Regular-market value only; blocks are shown below. The top 10 accounted for ₱4.32B, or 68% of main-board value. ICT alone was 20%, and BDO's ₱1.05B (16%) was regular trading with no block crosses.

BLOCK SALES

Security	Crosses	Price (P)	Volume	Value (PM)
MER	1	580.99	21,414,758	12,441.8
EMI	1	14.38	58,667,400	843.6
BPI	3	94.95 – 95.60	4,204,470	401.8
RLC	2	16.22	21,000,800	340.6
ICT	1	895.41	300,000	268.6
SMPH	3	15.86 – 16.30	14,293,600	232.4
PGOLD	1	40.08	4,270,000	171.2
COL	1	1.20	50,000,000	60.0
Total	13		174,151,028	14,759.9

The MER cross alone was 84% of block value; without it, blocks were ₱2.32B. EMI crossed 58.7M shares at ₱14.38, 5% below its ₱15.20 close, and COL crossed 50M shares at ₱1.20, 21% below its ₱1.52 close. BPI's three crosses (₱94.95–95.60) and ICT's (₱895.41) printed above the close, probably early in the session before the sell-off. A VWAP trade of 116,000 BPI shares at ₱93.48 (₱10.8M) also printed. The desk reported large crosses in SMC as well, but the DQR block table has none.

PSEI-30 CONSTITUENT TRACKER

Symbol	Close	% Chg	High	Low	Net Foreign
AC	530.00	▼ -1.85%	540.00	526.50	(58.7M)
ACEN	2.73	▲ +0.74%	2.73	2.64	+0.6M
AEV	38.25	▲ +0.13%	38.75	37.50	(1.7M)
ALI	15.26	▼ -0.91%	15.40	15.14	+4.5M
AREIT	36.80	▼ -0.41%	36.95	36.65	(1.2M)
BDO	111.00	▼ -0.18%	112.90	110.50	(48.8M)
BLOOM	1.92	0.00%	1.96	1.92	(0.6M)
BPI	93.00	▼ -2.72%	95.60	93.00	(14.7M)
CBC	49.20	▲ +0.92%	49.50	48.80	+4.5M
CNPF	32.85	▼ -0.15%	33.00	32.40	(1.0M)
CNVRG	8.77	▼ -0.34%	8.81	8.75	+0.6M
DMC	7.16	▼ -1.51%	7.27	7.00	(16.7M)
EMI	15.20	▲ +0.53%	15.30	15.08	+5.7M
GLO	1,516.0	▼ -0.98%	1,550.0	1,511.0	(70.7M)
GTCAP	418.00	▼ -0.48%	427.00	417.00	+30.2M
ICT	841.50	▼ -5.93%	898.00	841.50	(326.4M)
JFC	139.90	▼ -0.78%	141.40	139.50	+3.1M
JGS	16.60	▼ -3.26%	17.26	16.54	(8.0M)
LTG	15.56	▲ +0.78%	15.56	15.22	+7.3M
MBT	60.05	▼ -3.30%	61.55	60.05	(178.1M)
MER	415.00	▲ +0.24%	423.80	410.00	+17.0M
MONDE	6.19	▲ +2.65%	6.19	6.05	+2.5M
PLUS	7.30	▼ -3.95%	7.84	7.11	(2.9M)
RCR	6.28	▲ +1.29%	6.29	6.16	+4.5M
SCC	11.00	▼ -13.39%	12.38	10.90	(35.2M)
SM	522.50	▲ +1.26%	528.00	514.00	+45.0M
SMC	61.50	▲ +2.67%	67.45	59.90	(9.7M)
SMPH	15.82	▼ -2.94%	16.30	15.66	(275.3M)
TEL	1,111.0	▼ -2.37%	1,139.0	1,111.0	(15.1M)
URC	57.00	▲ +1.15%	57.75	56.40	+17.6M

11 up / 18 down / 1 unchanged. Equal-weighted average -1.10%, against -2.20% for the cap-weighted PSEi, because the heavily weighted ICT, MBT and SMPH fell hardest. SMC (+2.67%), MONDE (+2.65%) and RCR (+1.29%) led; SCC (-13.39%), ICT (-5.93%), PLUS (-3.95%), MBT (-3.30%) and JGS (-3.26%) lagged. % change vs the Oct 7 close.

CORPORATE STANCE CARDS

● MONITOR SMC ₱61.50 (+2.67%) — Spiked to ₱67.45 intraday; its dollar perpetuals yield 8.5–9%

SMC opened at ₱59.90, hit ₱67.45 and closed at ₱61.50 on only ₱14.3M of regular value, with foreign selling of ₱9.7M. The desk reported large block trades in SMC and MER by BDO Securities; the DQR block table shows the MER cross but none in SMC, so the SMC activity is not confirmed in the official record. Separately, the 8.5–9% yields on SMC Global Power's US-dollar perpetual securities price in aggressive financial leverage, heavy capex and structural risks, and reflect the extra compensation investors want for offshore subordinated notes. That is a funding-cost signal for the group, not a reason to chase the equity spike.

● MONITOR AT (Atlas Mining) ₱17.50 (–7.21%) — Fell on weaker copper; results due Oct 23

AT dropped from ₱18.86 to ₱17.50 (high ₱19.06, low ₱17.02) on ₱150.0M of value, the 10th most active name, with foreign selling of ₱16.4M. A pause in China's copper demand is the swing factor. Results are due Oct 23. Wait for copper to stabilize before adding.

● MONITOR ALI · SMPH · RLC Property — S&P: residential recovery may take until late 2027

The Property index fell 1.02% to 1,743.69. ALI slipped 0.91% to ₱15.26 and held above our ₱14.94 review level. SMPH fell 2.94% with ₱275.3M of foreign selling and ₱232.4M of block crosses at ₱15.86–16.30. RLC was flat (–0.12%) despite ₱94.0M of foreign selling and two ₱16.22 crosses worth ₱340.6M. Hold ALI above ₱14.94, and make no new purchases in SMPH.

● MONITOR JGS ₱16.60 (–3.26%) — A Gokongwei-led airport proposal failed its completeness review

BusinessWorld reported on Oct 8 that a Gokongwei-led airport proposal failed its completeness review (we could not open the full article, so the project and next steps are unconfirmed). JGS fell 3.26% on a ₱16.54–17.26 range with ₱23.1M of value and foreign selling of ₱8.0M. We do not attribute the whole move to this headline.

- **Also in the news:** Prime Infra and LNGPH prequalified for the first gas capacity auction. Bloomberg launched an online gaming livestreaming platform (BLOOM flat at ₱1.92). DOE cited promising signs in Koloma hydrogen exploration. Share buyback transactions on Oct 8: OPM, FRUIT, CNVRG, COSCO and URC.

SMARTWATCH — WHAT MOVES THE TAPE NEXT

- **Today (Fri Oct 9):** Asian reaction to oil above \$102 and the Persian Gulf headlines; US inflation data, Fed commentary and Treasury auctions; USD-PHP against ₱63.00. Any PSE disclosure explaining the MER ₱12.44B cross.
- **Mon Oct 12:** Mynt public offer (₱6.60) closes. Check the FCG tender offer terms and deadline.
- **Oct 14–15:** SEC comment deadlines (broker capital floor Oct 14, debt collectors Oct 15) and Meralco's 900MW expressions of interest. Oct 20: Mynt listing. Oct 23: AT results.
- **Levels:** PSEi support 5,584 (Nov-2025 low), then 5,500; resistance 5,745, then 5,826. ICT revisit above ₱895; GLO re-entry ₱1,555; AC hold ₱500; ALI review ₱14.94; USD-PHP ceiling ₱63.00, support ₱61.94.

PSE DIVY 20 TRACKER

Symbol	Close	% Chg	High	Low	Net Foreign
AEV	38.25	▲ +0.13%	38.75	37.50	(1.7M)
AREIT	36.80	▼ -0.41%	36.95	36.65	(1.2M)
CBC	49.20	▲ +0.92%	49.50	48.80	+4.5M
CREIT	2.89	▼ -0.34%	2.91	2.87	(4.4M)
DMC	7.16	▼ -1.51%	7.27	7.00	(16.7M)
DNL	3.36	▼ -0.88%	3.40	3.35	(0.3M)
GLO	1,516.0	▼ -0.98%	1,550.0	1,511.0	(70.7M)
LTG	15.56	▲ +0.78%	15.56	15.22	+7.3M
MBT	60.05	▼ -3.30%	61.55	60.05	(178.1M)
MER	415.00	▲ +0.24%	423.80	410.00	+17.0M
MREIT	13.40	▲ +0.30%	13.44	13.32	(2.0M)
NIKL	3.87	▼ -1.53%	3.94	3.82	(0.6M)
OGP	34.45	▼ -1.01%	34.75	34.40	(2.3M)
PGOLD	40.00	▼ -1.23%	40.75	39.90	(10.7M)
RCR	6.28	▲ +1.29%	6.29	6.16	+4.5M
RLC	16.20	▼ -0.12%	16.24	15.74	(94.0M)
SCC	11.00	▼ -13.39%	12.38	10.90	(35.2M)
SGP	22.00	▼ -1.12%	22.45	21.90	+1.8M
TEL	1,111.0	▼ -2.37%	1,139.0	1,111.0	(15.1M)
URC	57.00	▲ +1.15%	57.75	56.40	+17.6M

7 up / 13 down. Equal-weighted average -1.17%. RCR (+1.29%), URC (+1.15%) and LTG (+0.78%) led; SCC (-13.39%), MBT (-3.30%), TEL (-2.37%) and DMC (-1.51%) lagged. RLC drew ₱94.0M of foreign selling on a flat price. Index level N/A (not published in DQR summary tables). Composition per PSE as of Sep 30, 2026.

PSE MIDCAP 20 TRACKER

Symbol	Close	% Chg	High	Low	Net Foreign
AGI	8.88	▲ +0.68%	8.94	8.81	(0.3M)
APX	16.32	▼ -4.45%	16.96	16.32	(15.0M)
BLOOM	1.92	0.00%	1.96	1.92	(0.6M)
CNVRG	8.77	▼ -0.34%	8.81	8.75	+0.6M
COSCO	7.33	▼ -0.27%	7.38	7.30	(0.4M)
DNL	3.36	▼ -0.88%	3.40	3.35	(0.3M)
GSMI	216.00	▲ +0.47%	216.80	211.40	+0.6M
KEEPR	1.80	▲ +3.45%	1.80	1.74	+1.1M
MEG	2.16	▼ -0.46%	2.18	2.15	+1.9M
MREIT	13.40	▲ +0.30%	13.44	13.32	(2.0M)
MWC	31.85	▼ -1.09%	32.90	31.05	(71.2M)
NIKL	3.87	▼ -1.53%	3.94	3.82	(0.6M)
OGP	34.45	▼ -1.01%	34.75	34.40	(2.3M)
PNB	73.80	▼ -1.60%	75.00	73.25	+5.2M
PX	10.86	▼ -2.34%	11.12	10.68	(5.1M)
RLC	16.20	▼ -0.12%	16.24	15.74	(94.0M)
SECB	61.55	▲ +0.33%	62.00	61.05	+1.9M
SEVN	30.00	▲ +1.52%	33.00	29.95	(0.2M)
SGP	22.00	▼ -1.12%	22.45	21.90	+1.8M
WLCON	5.50	0.00%	5.56	5.48	(0.2M)

6 up / 12 down / 2 unchanged. Equal-weighted average -0.42%, the mildest of the three trackers. KEEP R (+3.45%), SEVN (+1.52%) and AGI (+0.68%) led; APX (-4.45%), PX (-2.34%) and PNB (-1.60%) lagged, and MWC (-1.09%) drew ₱71.2M of foreign selling. Index level N/A (not published in DQR summary tables). Composition per PSE as of Sep 30, 2026.

LEARN — READING BLOCK SALES

The concept. A block sale, or cross, is a large trade negotiated between a buyer and a seller in advance and reported on the exchange's block board instead of going through the regular order book. Because the price is agreed beforehand, it can sit far from the screen price, and it does not move the stock's regular trading price.

The arithmetic. The MER cross was 21,414,758 shares at ₱580.99, or ₱12.44B. The close was ₱415, so the buyer paid ₱165.99 more per share, a 40% premium worth about ₱3.55B in total. The block was about 1.9% of Meralco's 1,127M shares. A premium like that usually pays for a strategic stake, a transfer between related holders, or a special arrangement, not for ordinary investment demand.

Applied to today's market. Headline value of ₱21.14B included ₱14.76B of blocks. Strip them out and regular main-board value was ₱6.37B, still up from ₱4.42B on Oct 7, but less than a third of the headline. The index fell 2.2% on the regular market, not on the block.

Takeaway. Read blocks separately. A turnover spike from one cross says little about market participation or direction; look at regular value, breadth and foreign flows instead, and check the PSE disclosures to learn who traded and why.

Reference: Investopedia, "Block Trade". Illustrative arithmetic only; not a DAMS fair-value estimate.

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